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r/GooglePixel • 1mo ago

Practical_Garlic6134 Top 1% Poster

...

SCAM ALERT: Google Japan physically DESTROYED my Pixel 9 Pro Fold to avoid their Extended Warranty (Proof Inside)

[UPDATE: Case closed after supervisor came in. Try to post on Reddit ASAP if you encounter problems with CS and keep the evidence.]

I need to share a nightmare experience with Google Support Japan.

The Background: My Pixel 9 Pro Fold suffered from the **Selfie Camera failure**, which is a widely known issue (Reference: [Link to Support Thread](#)). I actually found the official **Extended Warranty Program** for this issue and shared it in the community. **My post was even marked as a "Recommended Answer" by the official team.** I followed the exact official steps to get it replaced.

The Setup: My phone had 3-4 small hairline cracks on the outer screen, but it was fully functional, and no glass was missing.

- **Google's Promise:** Support confirmed that if I paid the fee to fix the cosmetic cracks, they would replace the unit for free under the Camera Warranty. I agreed and sent it in.
- **The Proof:** When Google received it, their agent emailed me confirming the device had **"Only Cracks"** (See Proof 1).

The Destruction: However, while the phone was being processed for return, they suddenly emailed me claiming that **"both screens are damaged"** (Inner and Outer). I immediately replied to ask what they meant (since they confirmed "Only Cracks" earlier), but **they completely ignored me.**

When I finally received the box, I understood why.

- **Outer Screen:** A chunk of glass is physically MISSING.
- **Inner Screen:** Leaking OLED fluid, black spots everywhere.
- **Hinge:** Broken. It makes weird noises.

The Proof (They Lied): They claimed they "could not reproduce the camera issue" on my original phone. **That is a lie.** Even though they smashed my screen, **I was able to reproduce the camera failure in just 5 seconds** on the returned, destroyed unit. I recorded a video of it. If I can see the failure in 5 seconds on a broken screen, how did their "experts" miss it on a working phone? They simply didn't check.

The Absurd Logic: Here is the worst part. Even yesterday, after I showed them the photos of the damage **THEY caused**, they are still telling me:

"Because the device has physical damage, it is not eligible for the Extended Warranty program."

Think about this:

1. I sent them a working phone for a camera repair.
2. They (or their center) smashed it.
3. Now they say, "We can't fix it under warranty because it's smashed."

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(CAA) tomorrow. **Has anyone else had their device destroyed by the repair center?** Maybe it is common in Japan because I also just found this [recent post](#).

1. Test results (in Japanese but translated in Gmail):

<https://imgur.com/a/oVbhW4N>

2. Camera issue (you can also see the damaged corner):

<https://imgur.com/a/CsaEGUS>

3. Inner display (perfect before):

<https://imgur.com/a/j6sPibr>

Updated: 1/14/2026

I'm currently busy with work and will travel on business from today. However, I have to share **the absolute joke that is Google Support recently**

1/12: I got an email from Agent Kaori. While they politely admitted to the discrepancy between their initial test results and the condition of the device I received, he/she started with

Dear Mikasa,

Unfortunately, that is the name of the previous agent instead of mine (or someone from *Attack on Titan* I guess). He promised that their specialist team will check this discrepancy and get back to me soon. This sounds nice so I replied with thanks, although he asked me to agree with some usages of my info for the third time.

1/13: Then, Agent Misaka came back. She seems to be pissed off by Agent Kaori's helpful attitude and taking over the case. She emailed me, with all these incredible arguments:

Responsibility for Loss or Damage During Shipping**
 Please note that **you** (and not your service provider or Google) are **solely responsible** for any **loss or damage** that may occur during shipping of your device. We recommend that you package and handle your device properly to avoid any issues during shipping.

So basically what they say is that if you are a delivery guy from some shipping company, if you see RMA on the package, you can simply throw it away because it won't be your fault. This contradicts Agent Kaori, who already admitted the discrepancy, indicating the device was fine when they received it.

Device Inspection
 We are also happy to **confirm that no evidence of damage was found**. Your device was carefully inspected during this process to ensure it meets our quality standards.

Yeah, my phone is doing well, thanks for asking!

Where the inspection was performed
 Your device was inspected at one of our **repair centers**, where our team assessed the condition of the device.

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As mentioned above, your inquiry has been escalated to our internal team and we are currently working towards a resolution. Our team has reviewed the details and provided all relevant information regarding the damage and concerns you have reported.

If you can not decide or properly report anything from your team, then please shut up.

Summary: I feel like their support team is now completely chaotic and has started infighting. I have briefly consulted with the local agency by phone, and will hopefully see them in person when I come back.

1/14: Support agent "Mikasa" just replied somehow with a NEW Case ID in the support page and stated that Google is not liable for any damages during.

Here is the translation of their email:

"Regarding the damage during the return shipment... please note that we cannot be held responsible for accidents or damages caused by the delivery carrier."

Why this is ILLEGAL & ABSURD:

1. I did not hire the carrier. Google did. Under Japanese law, the sender is responsible for the package until it reaches the customer. I am not responsible for any damage that occurred during the shipment.
2. Evidence ignored: They are completely ignoring the previous agent (Mulan)'s record which confirmed the device arrived at their facility with "Only Cracks".
3. **Violation of Consumer Contract Act:** In Japan, the Consumer Contract Act (Article 8) invalidates any clause that completely exempts a business from liability for damages caused by its negligence (including that of its subcontractors/couriers).

They are literally telling me: "Yes, we (or our courier) broke it, but our terms say we don't have to pay."

Thanks for admitting you want to **BREAK THE LAW**, Google!

Updated: 1/20/2026

The Outcome: After escalating the case, Supervisors (Muta and Shimada) stepped in and went above and beyond:

1. Full Refund via Store Credit: Instead of a standard replacement, they refunded the full retail price of the P10PF as Store Credit.
2. Free Upgrade: I used the credit (combined with my student discount) to order a brand new Pixel 10 Pro Fold.
3. Fees Waived: They even waived the repair fee for the outer screen damage I initially agreed to pay.
4. Insurance: Since this counts as a "new purchase," I can finally add Preferred Care legitimately.

Advice if you are stuck in RMA limbo: If standard support is failing you, here is what worked for me:

1. Be Clear, Not Just Angry: Don't just vent. Explain the actual impact (e.g., "This is my main driver," "I am exhausted by the delays").
2. Ask for Supervisors: Tier 1 support is limited by the script. Supervisors have the authority to waive fees or issue credits. For me, the turning point is this reddit post. I have to say I am very upset that it seems that posting in reddit is the only way to talk to an reasonable human.

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Faith in Google Support (contacting from Reddit) restored. Case closed!

519

88

[Share](#)[Join the conversation](#)Sort by: **Best** ▾ [Search Comments](#)**praetorian125** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

Google CS is the same world over.

**rExplrer** • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

It is really commendable that Google is able to maintain same quality CS around the world.

**Expensive_Finger_973** • 1mo ago

It really is. They give such a consistent experience that you can always depend on.

**aykcak** • 1mo ago

I am curious is it the same in U.S. ? Somehow a U.S. company treating the world of customers as shit makes more sense than doing the same in the U.S.

**rExplrer** • 1mo ago

Yes same in the US

**Far_Specific4836** 🍰 • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

You should just file today. They just don't give a shit.

**Practical_Garlic6134** OP • 1mo ago

Top 1% Poster

Today is a holiday in Japan haha, I will do is asap

**Mussels84** • 1mo ago

Pixel 4 XL + Pixel XL

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The final time they kept for months til it went past the 2 year warranty so they could just refuse it entirely

**brunn08** • 1mo ago

For european countries the warranty time freezes while the equipment is being repaired by the manufacturer. Probably you have similar laws elsewhere.

**Mussels84** • 1mo ago

Pixel 4 XL + Pixel XL

I don't think they cared about laws since there was a global recall and free battery swap at the time

They also told me my Google mesh router is fine at 25Mb local wifi speeds because I didn't have gigabit internet. I gave up on the company.

**andobrah** • 1mo ago

Reading shit like this and googles continued attempts at ruining android are making me want to swap to iphone more and more each day.. they aren't much better but I'm over googles BS at this point

**ResponsibleQuiet6611** • 1mo ago[r/GrapheneOS](#) [r/degoogle](#)**SINDicate** • 1mo ago

Surely you understand the irony here

**Mussels84** • 1mo ago

Pixel 4 XL + Pixel XL

Fortunately I've had no such issues with Samsungs

**andobrah** • 1mo ago

Its still android and Samsung aren't very privacy friendly either unfortunately

**Mussels84** • 1mo ago

Pixel 4 XL + Pixel XL

No smartphone is privacy friendly. Google hardware is the problem here, their customer support is world class - at the bottom.



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**Fragrant-Carrot-3307** • 27d ago

I'm switching to apply once my pixel 9 dies. They're infuriating. It seems like they have a playbook because everyone's experiences seem similar to mine.

**Agent_Jay_42** • 1mo ago

<https://support.google.com/product-documentation/answer/9322027?hl=en-AU>

**mathurprateek725** • 1mo ago

wtf

**SweatyAdagio4** • 1mo ago

Not surprised Google CS is shit there too. In Europe, they've been using a scheme to avoid warranty claims for a variety of devices, but a lot of battery replacement and screen replacement scams are in place to avoid warranty claims on the Pixel 8 and Pixel 9.

I made a megapost about this months ago, collecting similar posts and listing them out. You send your phone for a screen repair due to the infamous vertical line issue on pixel 8 and 9 devices, or the battery issue, and then when at the scam center in Poland, they would make up some bogus issue like "damage to the outside of the device" or "speaker mesh damage" to somehow claim they don't have to repair it free of charge, even though European law says otherwise (partial repairs for issue within warranty). But CS just ignores you.

Pixel 8 is my first and last pixel device. I spent two months without my pixel 8 since it was being sent from place to place before I finally got it back unrepaired. Google is a scam

**SlikR** • 1mo ago

I had a similar issue and had to complain on X publicly to their profile. Then I had to have all my friends message them on the same post. Only after doing all that did they fix my phone.

**TonightConsistent560** • 28d ago

Advice: before every sending. Record and pics of what you put int he box. After receiving any product, before opening, record the unboxing showing the seal are still untouched (of course never accept a box with damaged seal)

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**koreandramalife** • 1mo ago

I'm sorry that you have this terrible experience with Google CS. Please keep us posted on the complaint that you will be filing with the Consumer Affairs Agency.

I had mentioned in a few separate posts that Google's CS is sub-par and can't compare to ㄹ's. I came to this conclusion after I reached out to them about getting a replacement for my slightly over one-month-old 10 Pro XL. Since I got it in early December, it hasn't managed to give the right answer to "Hey Google, what's my location?" Always off by a mile at least, or three. And throughout the day, which I documented via screen shots. As a result, my micro weather forecast is never accurate as it's not specific to where I live, an area that covers a stretch that's prone to both floods and landslides.

The Google CS was okay at the start, but when I told him that I had done all the required troubleshooting, and that only a unit replacement would satisfy me, his online demeanor changed. He sent me one thick chunk of a seven-sentence paragraph (that he could have broken down into bullet points for easier reading) that contained action points from me. And he expected me to have read and made my decision after 90 freaking seconds. Unbelievable. I told him that he sounded impatient, and that ㄹ Customer Service didn't behave that way. He gave a half-ass apology, and said that it was what they were trained to do.

After this experience, I will never again buy anything from Google. The 10PXL is my first and my last Google device.

**Practical_Garlic6134** OP • 1mo ago

Top 1% Poster

Thank you for sharing your story. It's unbelievable that they expected you to read and decide in 90 seconds! That 'online demeanor change' is exactly what I experienced too—once they realize they might actually have to replace the unit, they turn into robots. I originally planned to file the complaint today (Monday), but realized it's a holiday here. I also have a super busy week traveling ahead and I'm currently without my main SIM card (eSIM struggles), so I might not be able to do it immediately tomorrow. But I promise I will file the complaint as soon as I can and keep you guys updated. Hopefully, my case can set a precedent for us all.

**uniquorndawg** • 1mo ago

Before bringing any official proceedings against Google, make sure you have a backup of your data (photos, emails, etc.) in case Google puts a block on your Gmail account, which they are known to do when things get serious.

**Damn-Sky** • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

maybe they tried to open the phone for fixing and accidentally broke the back and front panels.

that's messed up man. good luck.

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**Apprenensive_Kice_85** • 28d ago

Yeah this isn't new. Google customer support is fucking atrocious, and they get away with it.

Also, god forbid you make too much of a fuss or draw too much attention and they'll close your Google account and you'll have no recourse.

**[deleted]** • 1mo ago

I stopped buying Pixel phone when they sent me the Japanese version rather than the USA version of the phone. I called them and said there was nothing they could do even though it was purchased on the Google website. It was a Pixel 8 Pro. I will never buy another Pixel Phone.

**woodsja2** • 1mo ago

Has anyone else had their device destroyed by the repair center?

Yes. My experience is with the US-based customer service for the Pixel.

I sent my phone in because the screen wasn't working. There was no physical damage to my phone. They said it was broken when they received it and gave me the run around while it was there then sent it back after denying the claim. [This is what it looked like when I got it back.](#)

I took them to small claims court. I was a little disappointed they didn't show up because I'd prepared a bunch. They did send a filing to the court that arrived a day late for the hearing. I was granted judgement since they didn't have anything for the judge by hearing date.

I think the root cause for my issue was [the crappy packaging](#) they used for RMA. They did made a blanket statement that they cover damage in transit if I use their packaging but good luck getting them to honor it.

I will not buy a phone from Google again and I've had about 5 including a Nexus One. I encourage anyone considering a new phone to reflect on the poor history of customer service that Google chooses and consider another option.

**shauggy** • 28d ago

Curious of the outcome in small claims, did they refund you what you were asking for? And did they close your Google account, or do anything punitive?

**woodsja2** • 27d ago

As part of the small claims process, I had to list a specific dollar value that would remedy the situation. I added up things like the court filing fee, printing costs, the replacement value of the phone, the taxes, and shipping and listed that sum in the court filing. Because it's small claims, I don't think either party can bill for hours.

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Overall, it took 10-15 hours of prep and research so borderline not worth it. I think I only won on the technicality that they didn't show up.



MarionberryOld2784 • 26d ago

Did they close your Google account?



woodsja2 • 25d ago

Not yet (knock on wood).



Double_Elderberry_92 • 28d ago • Edited 28d ago

Almost as consistent(ly bad) as the McDonalds experience worldwide 🤔



NFSNOOB • 28d ago

I mean because we speak about Google service in Japan.. the McDonald's in Japan is actually better than the global variants.. at least Europe own experience and what people say in the internet else where



[deleted] • 28d ago

This is just another reason to avoid Google hardware as a whole. Sorry you're having to go through this madness.



norhcnyS • 28d ago

I would advise against buying Google crappy phone for everybody. No matter how good the reviewers mentioned. I bought it when mkbhd says it was good but its just hardware junk.



PixelCommunity • 27d ago

Official Google Account Top 1% Commenter

Hey, can you please check your chat? I just sent you a message.



Budget-Sea-6645 • 26d ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**spaceindaver** • 1mo ago

They accepted my money, then sent no packaging or information about how to do the trade-in. My wife dropped her phone yesterday, so our house needs another one.

I'm most of the way through building my NAS setup so I can self-host cloud services and remove as many tech-giant subscriptions from my life.

I've just ordered a OnePlus 15.

What a shitshow companies like Alphabet and Meta are. You've got enough money that you could have incredible customer service and build lifelong advocates, but instead they build shit UIs, fuck up their customer service, and randomly delete services that hundreds of thousands of people use.

**tkshk** • 1mo ago

Get Galaxy or iPhone.

**Procontroller40** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

There are still a few other options, but I don't expect to ever buy another device made by Google.

**PineapplePizza99** • 1mo ago

Default

If you want good customer service there is only one option and that's Apple

**Procontroller40** • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

I've had good experiences with Sony and Samsung customer service for other devices, and there's also other Android manufacturers. Apple has improved but still isn't anywhere near an option for me since iOS is such a chore to use.

Edit: buying from retail outlets instead of directly from Google (or wherever else) can help mitigate some customer service issues. If you end up with a defective device during the return period, anyway.

**Admixues** • 1mo ago

Pixel 6 Pro

All these horror stories are the reason why I'll suck it up and just not get a pixel again, my 6 pro is still going strong but with Google QC a Chinese phone with no warranty is probably a safer buy especially with how cosmetic Google's warranty is.

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never buying google products again tbh

**MMoo7** • 1mo ago

Pixel 6

And here I was considering upgrading my P6 to the 10 pro, but now honor's magic 8 pro and s25 ultra seems like better choices.

Hope it goes well with you brother.

**Kolognial** • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

Don't expect Samsung's service to be better.

In case of a defect Samsung's official website directs you to a local Samsung repair center, where people in Samsung uniforms wearing Samsung name tags sell and repair, who would have guessed, only Samsung products.

But if anything goes wrong, Samsung will deny any responsibility because the repair center is not part of Samsung.

(The whole situation is illegal in the EU and their excuse is bullshit, but who is going to sue over some old, used phone?)

**Sitb28** • 1mo ago

This is one of the reasons why people choose iPhones or Samsung above Google. I have experienced something similar with my Pixel 5.

**Nehal1802** • 1mo ago**Nervous_Operation243** • 1mo ago

I'd advise everyone to avoid buying pixels. My 4 and now 7 pro have been completely fucked up while my friend who bought a S10 and then a S22 has had zero problems other than the usual intentional battery degrade. Pixels are quite fragile compared to the Samsungs.

**Mawfk** • 1mo ago

Ya but my friend has had zero issues with any of their pixels over the years. Has also had many issues with Samsung.

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not just a company that doesn't want to repair your device. This is destruction of property.



9pointkid • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

S25 Ultra, S25+, 10 Pro, 7, 6a, 6, 4a, 3

I cracked the code a while ago. Unless money is no object, there's no need to buy the most expensive model. Wait for a good deal or a major discount. When your phone inevitably breaks (as many do) just toss it and grab a new one. Skip the hassle of dealing with terrible customer service. It's a throwaway society, which sucks, but that's the reality we're stuck with. Customer service isn't about fixing your phone; it's designed to make you feel good about spending big on a device. It's all part of the illusion to get you to buy their products.

For example, we replaced our Pixel 7s, which were showing signs of degradation, like poor battery life and big overheating issues. We shopped around and recently picked up a couple of Galaxy phones on sale probably because the new models are about to drop. I paid \$360 for a S25+ and my wife spent \$630 on a Ultra. If the S25+ lasts two years, that works out to just \$0.50 per day. Having such a useful device for that cost feels like a good deal. If it starts to have problems after that no worries just toss it and buy a new one.



shinjikun10 • 1mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

I don't know anything about OP's case and can't speak to why he decided to send it to Google. However, I'll just speak about Softbank:

Softbank in Japan has their own warranty. I've had a problem with my other Android phone, but my P8P also has Softbank's direct fix and replacement warranty. You just go into any softbank store, and tell them you'd like your phone fixed. They will give you a temporary phone to use. Then they will send your phone out for repair.

The Pixel is only available at Softbank in Japan, and I have no idea OP's situation and can only speak about personal experience. I have a Japanese Pixel from Softbank and I have Softbank now.



Practical_Garlic6134 OP • 1mo ago

🏆 Top 1% Poster

Actually, the Pixel has been available on the Google Store JP (SIM-free) and other carriers like Docomo and au for years now. Mine is directly from the Google Store, so I have to deal with Google Support, not Softbank.



shinjikun10 • 1mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

That's right....you can buy the Pixel directly from Google, but I have no idea how carrier setup works in that situation. I didn't even know docomo had it.

Softbank's warranty will cover everything including a cracked screen and water damage. Basically anything wrong with the phone.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**Practical_Garlic6134** OP • 1mo ago

Top 1% Poster

Haha, I think my case might be one of the top horror stories now! 🤪 Thanks for the well wishes. Next time I might just stick to a carrier for peace of mind

**th3bigfatj** • 28d ago

Google has really enshittified the consumer experience.

When the next administration comes to power we really need to look at ways to pursue reasonable regulation around search engines and inclusion with browsers and operating systems. Google's current search engine monopoly is very bad for consumers and it would be great to see it broken up.

**CanadianDiver** • 1mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Sure they did. That is how they become market dominant... But selling broken devices and refusing to service them.

Google is a scam. Sure thing.

**xxohioanxx** • 1mo ago

4% market share is market dominance?

**CanadianDiver** • 1mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Google at 4% eh?

**xxohioanxx** • 1mo ago

Yes, Pixels have 4% market share.

**CanadianDiver** • 1mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

I didn't say pixel, I said Google. They are involved in retailing a lot more than pixel phones.

**xxohioanxx** • 1mo ago

Which is irrelevant because we're talking about their support for Pixel phones, which is famously terrible, as you can see from the daily posts in this sub.

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Should have used the insurance, if you paid for it. I got the 9pro fold last year and paid for the preferred care. Dropped it last month and cracked the front screen. Submitted a claim to get a replacement had to pay like ¥14000. They sent me a 10pro fold instead.

**cutebluedragongirl** • 1mo ago

LMAO.

**mcrksman** • 28d ago

So not only is Google, throwing away the one advantage they had over iPhone but turning android into iOS, they're trying to compete while having non-existent customer support?

It's almost as if they want people to switch to iPhone

**Helpful-Limit715** • 28d ago

Don't trust corporate, they think profit only.

**VimFueago** • 28d ago**No-Cap-9873** • 27d ago

Google: we hate our customers

**koreandramalife** • 27d ago

Got my Pixel 10 Pro XL replacement unit yesterday. It looked brand new. Still saddled with that old problem of not knowing where it is though. Did a "Hey Google, what's my location?" Off by 0.6mi. Two different ZIP codes.

After transferring my apps to the new unit, the "Add to Home Screen" option on Chrome disappeared. Cleared the cache. Restarted the phone several times. Nothing worked until I did a factory reset. Didn't realize Android is so buggy compared to iOS.

The saving grace was the Google CS who was attentive and patient, unlike the punk who was rushing me a few nights ago. Third party widgets (e.g., Apple Music and FB) still freeze and become unusable, but the Amazon widget is no longer available this time around.



Create



Reading through this and I'm infuriated because it seems like their customer service philosophy is just "gas light them".

Their customer service gaslighted me when I was trying to trade-in my tablet in 2024. They did pretty much what they did to you.



ngbtri • 27d ago

Holy fk



suncontrolspecies • 27d ago

What the fuck, why people keep buying or using google shit? Yes I know "android" but you have de-google alternatives or even things like mainline Linux for phones such as Ubuntu Touch



Budget-Sea-6645 • 26d ago

Mine also bought in Japan. On my first RMA, it will be exchanged to pixel 10 fold. But I cannot see any return label or manual so Google Support removed it. Then after contacted support team, they create the second one is "repair" and I have to pay 75000 yen, which is around \$450 as a deposit fee. Then after review they will refund (or change the fee). Holly f to Google for this case.



Background_Bed_5410 • 26d ago

Pixel 10 | Google Legacy ©



One-Ad2165 • 26d ago

I'm Japanese, but Google's support is crap, so I take it to a service provider like iCracked. I guess I wouldn't have had any problems with iCracked.